

Means of expression

There are many things an individual can do to personalize an outfit, and the teen years are a great time to try things out and experiment.

Clothes

If a person's clothes feel comfortable and fit well, they will look good, too. It's worth finding a few staple, good-quality items that can be dressed up or down. Some people make their own clothing, which is a clever and fun way to fill a wardrobe.



Hair

Long or short, curly or straight, styled or natural, the options are endless for how to wear hair. Many people find a style that they like and stick to it, while others experiment day by day. Sometimes, a person's decisions reflect their cultural or religious identity.

Make-up

Wearing make-up can accentuate an individual's features, cover up blemishes, and be dramatic or natural. It can help a person to feel more confident in their looks, and is often fun to experiment with—for boys and girls alike. Of course, it can be just as expressive to wear no make-up at all.



▽ Unique look

Body art is a way for a person to express their identity through their appearance.



GOOD TO KNOW

The risks

Piercings:

- can damage nerves if not done properly.
- can get infected if not cared for correctly.
- can close up if taken out for a prolonged period of time.

Tattoos:

- should be done hygienically. There are strict laws on sterilization in regard to tattoos. Using an unlicensed tattooist increases the risk of hepatitis and HIV infection.
- have a minimum age requirement, even with parental consent.
- can only be removed using a painful laser technique that breaks down the ink particles in the skin.

Piercings and tattoos

From ear-piercings to personalized tattoos, body art lets a person be extremely creative in how they look, but the permanence of these can be both a thrill and a problem. As a teen explores their identity during adolescence, they and their tastes change, so it's essential for an individual to think very carefully and take their time when considering getting a piercing or tattoo.